



I refused to fund the purchase of my son's DJ equipment. It reminded me of the mistake I had made decades earlier, going into debt by purchasing stereo equipment. My refusal did not deter him. He used the money he made working in the summer as a boat cleaner to buy it. It cost thousands, but he recouped it all and then some by getting paid DJing gigs. Linda worries that he does not get enough sleep at night to be alert in school, but he keeps his marks up and finds time to write music. You can hear his work at trevoroleary.com.

To Trevor's credit, he didn't make a spur-of-the-moment decision. He spent a couple months debating whether he should buy that tracker system and start his new small business. Then he did a little bit of research. He started going online, trying to figure out how to get the best deal on a system. In the end, he decided to buy certain components secondhand and other pieces new. He assembled them himself into a complete kit. Then he booked his first gig. It was a huge hit. The club went nuts—they loved his music! Now he's getting paid \$150 a night for his gigs. He sticks \$15 into his Secret 10 account after every gig, and his accounts are starting to grow. It's turning out to be a nice moneymaker for him. Yes, he wiped out his savings to buy the necessary equipment—but he made it back